

Feasibility Study

PlayGCC

Unified Multi-Sport Booking & Matchmaking Platform for Saudi Arabia

CS3151 — Software Engineering - Fall 2026

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1. General Information

Business Activity Name	PlayGCC
Business Idea	A mobile application that lets players in Saudi Arabia search and book padel, tennis, football, and swimming venues from a single real-time, multi-venue view, and that matches players missing a partner or a teammate with a verified, rated player nearby.
Reason for Choosing the Idea	Market research found no existing app in Saudi Arabia that combines multi-sport venue booking with a trust-based social matchmaking layer; the timing aligns with Vision 2030's Quality of Life Program and Saudi Arabia's fast-growing padel and football scenes.
Legal Form	Limited Liability Company (LLC), to be registered as an SME with Monsha'at

Partners

No.	Partner Name	Role	Ownership %
1	Hamed Almehdhar	CEO — product & venue partnerships	50%
2	Moayad Omar	CTO — app & AI development	30%
3	Hasan Albaiti	Head of Growth — marketing & B2B sales	20%

2. Executive Summary

PlayGCC is a mobile application that solves two linked problems for sports players in Saudi Arabia: the friction of booking padel, tennis, football, and swimming venues across multiple separate apps, and the difficulty of finding a trustworthy player to fill an open slot in a game. The app offers a single, real-time, multi-venue booking view, a one-tap Quick Match feature backed by verified profiles and two-way ratings, and split payment through Mada, STC Pay, and Apple Pay.

The Saudi sports market is growing quickly and is actively supported by government policy. Saudi Arabia is Asia's leading market for padel, with 431 facilities, 1,097 courts, and an estimated 400,000 amateur players as of 2024, and the Saudi Padel Committee's strategic plan targets 1,000 courts across 26 cities by 2030. This growth sits inside the broader push of Vision 2030's Quality of Life Program to raise sports participation nationally, which gives PlayGCC a policy tailwind that pure booking or pure matchmaking competitors do not have.

Competitor analysis found that no existing product combines multi-sport, multi-venue booking with a Saudi-first trust and safety layer: Malaeb is strong in social football matchmaking but weak outside that sport; Playtomic has excellent padel matchmaking but is not built for the Saudi market; Book and Go gives individual venues excellent booking software but no cross-venue marketplace for players. This leaves a clear, currently unaddressed gap for PlayGCC to fill.

The business model combines a per-booking commission from venues, a premium player subscription, and a B2B SaaS layer for smaller venues that do not have their own booking system, with corporate wellness packages as a longer-term revenue stream. Based on the illustrative three-year financial projection in Section 14, the business is expected to reach break-even in the second year of operation, supported by an initial capital requirement of approximately SAR 2.5 million.

3. Description of Products and Services

PlayGCC offers four related products and services, summarized below.

No.	Product/Service	Unique Features	Added Value	Customer Benefits
1	Consumer App — Booking & Matchmaking	Unified real-time view across padel, tennis, football & swimming venues; Quick Match; verified profiles & two-way ratings	Only app that spans all four sports and matches strangers safely	Saves time booking; never short a player; feels safe playing with someone new
2	Premium Subscription	Priority matching, unlimited Quick Match, no booking fees	Removes friction for frequent players	Lower cost per game for regular users; faster matches
3	B2B Venue Dashboard (SaaS)	Real-time booking management, dynamic off- peak pricing, demand forecasting	Gives small venues enterprise-grade tools without building their own app	Higher utilization and revenue for venue partners
4	Corporate Wellness Packages	Recurring bulk bookings for company sports programs	Turns Vision 2030's wellness push into a B2B revenue line	Simplifies employee wellness administration for HR teams

4. Technological Impact

Will technology have positive effects on the business?

- High smartphone penetration and growing cashless payment adoption in Saudi Arabia (Mada, STC Pay, Apple Pay) make a mobile-first booking and payment flow immediately usable by the target market.
- Nafath, the national digital identity platform, gives PlayGCC a ready-made, trusted way to verify players without building custom KYC infrastructure.
- AI can be used directly in the product: profile summarization, a smart scheduling assistant, and demand forecasting for venues all become differentiators rather than just efficiency gains.

Will technology have negative effects on the business?

- Dependence on third-party payment gateways and identity verification APIs creates a single point of failure if any provider has downtime or changes its terms.
- A well-funded competitor (regional or global) could copy the matchmaking or booking features quickly, since none of them are individually hard to replicate technically.

How will PlayGCC use technology to its advantage?

- Building the matchmaking and demand-forecasting models as core, defensible IP rather than commodity features.
- Using the WhatsApp Business API to meet users where they already are, given WhatsApp's dominant daily use in Saudi Arabia.

5. Country Economy

Saudi Arabia's macroeconomic position is stable and supportive of a consumer technology business targeting discretionary, leisure-related spending.

Indicator	Value
Real GDP growth	Forecast at approximately 4.6% for 2025–2026, following a period of oil-driven volatility in 2023–2024, as non-oil sectors continue to expand under Vision 2030
2025 government budget	Total revenues estimated at SAR 1.184 trillion against total expenditure of SAR 1.285 trillion, a planned deficit of roughly 2.3% of GDP, reflecting continued expansionary spending on diversification programs
Sovereign credit rating	A+ (S&P, March 2025), A+ (Fitch, February 2025), A1 with a Positive outlook (Moody's) — reflecting strong fiscal buffers and reform momentum
Economic trajectory	Growth and diversification, with non-oil GDP consistently outpacing oil GDP as Vision 2030 programs mature
Purchasing power / consumer spending	Rising urban disposable income and a young population (median age under 32) support growth in leisure and sports spending

These conditions favor PlayGCC: continued government investment in sports infrastructure and participation targets under Vision 2030's Quality of Life Program, combined with a stable credit outlook and rising non-oil consumer spending, reduce macroeconomic risk for a leisure-sector startup entering the market now.

6. Product or Service Market

Target Audience

- Casual and social padel, tennis, football, and swimming players in major Saudi cities (Riyadh, Jeddah, Dammam)
- Recurring teams and padel pairs who book the same weekly slot
- Women and family players seeking dedicated sessions
- Venue owners and managers without their own booking software
- Corporate wellness coordinators booking recurring employee slots

Market Size

Local Market Size	Imported / Competing Apps	Total Addressable Market
~400,000 amateur padel players nationally (2024), plus a larger base of casual football, tennis and swimming participants not separately tracked	Global apps (Playtomic) and regional apps (Yalla Hagz) currently serve a fraction of Saudi demand	Illustrative estimate: SAR 150–250 million in annual bookable court/pitch/pool spend across the four sports in target cities

Saudi Arabia is already Asia's leading padel market by facility count, with 431 facilities and 1,097 courts as of 2024, and the Saudi Padel Committee's 2025–2030 plan targets 1,000 courts across 26 cities and half a million practitioners. This existing, government-backed growth trajectory is the clearest evidence of unmet, expanding demand that a booking and matchmaking platform can capture.

Competitors and Demand

- Potential future competitors: Malaeb (football-focused, Gulf-wide), Playtomic (padel-focused, global), Book and Go (Saudi B2B booking SaaS), and single-venue apps such as Padel Breeze
- Demand currently outpaces organized supply: venues report booked-out peak hours and empty off-peak slots, indicating a scheduling/discovery gap rather than a lack of underlying demand
- Customers choose PlayGCC over competitors because it is the only product combining multi-sport coverage, Saudi-first identity verification, and a trust layer for playing with new people

7. Marketing Strategy

- Performance marketing on Instagram and Snapchat, the dominant channels for the 18–40 urban Saudi demographic that makes up the core player segment
 - A WhatsApp booking bot as both a product feature and an acquisition channel, given WhatsApp's near-universal daily use in Saudi Arabia
 - Venue-side co-marketing: in-club signage and staff referrals at partner venues, which reach players who are already primed to book
 - Referral incentives (free slot credit) to drive low-cost, high-trust word-of-mouth growth among existing sports communities
 - City leaderboards and community challenges to build retention and organic sharing, a model already proven effective by Malaeb's gamified community features
- These methods target the same audience directly (existing club-goers and sports-focused social media users), and the differentiation message centers on being the only Saudi-first, multi-sport, trust-verified option — directly addressing the gaps found in the competitor analysis.

8. Business Activity and Human Resources

Period	Employees Needed	Notes
First 3 months	4	Founding team: CEO, CTO, 1 developer, 1 venue partnerships lead
First 6 months	7	Add: 1 developer, 1 marketing/growth, 1 customer support
First year	12	Add: 2 developers, 1 data/AI specialist, 1 B2B sales, 1 additional support

Organizational Structure and Roles

No.	Job Title	Responsibilities	Required Qualifications
1	CEO	Overall strategy, venue partnerships, fundraising	Business/entrepreneurship background
2	CTO	App architecture, AI matchmaking engine, technical hiring	Software engineering, mobile & backend experience
3	Mobile Developers (2–3)	Build and maintain the iOS/Android app	React Native or native iOS/Android experience
4	Data/AI Specialist	Matchmaking model, demand forecasting, profile summarization	Machine learning / data science background
5	Head of Growth	Marketing, referral program, community growth	Digital marketing experience, Saudi market knowledge
6	B2B Sales / Partnerships Lead	Venue onboarding, B2B SaaS sales, account management	Sales experience, ideally in sports/leisure or SaaS
7	Customer Support (1–2)	Trust & safety operations, dispute handling, support tickets	Arabic/English bilingual, customer service experience

9. Timeline

No.	Task	Expected Date / Deadline
1	Completion of Operational Business Plan	Month 1
2	Funding Acquisition (seed round)	Months 2–3
3	Start of Hiring	Month 3
4	Trial Opening (Riyadh, limited venue partners)	Month 6
5	Grand Opening (Riyadh, Jeddah, Dammam)	Month 9

10. Technical Section

Location: headquartered in Riyadh, with venue partners across Riyadh, Jeddah, and Dammam — close to the largest concentrations of padel and football venues in the country •

Materials/inputs needed: cloud hosting and compute (for the app backend and AI models), mapping/location APIs, payment gateway integration, and Nafath identity verification integration •

Tools: standard mobile development stack (iOS/Android), cloud infrastructure (e.g. AWS/Azure), and third-party APIs for payments, maps, and WhatsApp Business messaging •

Suppliers: cloud infrastructure provider, payment gateway provider (Mada/STC Pay/Apple Pay integrator), Nafath/Absher integration partner, WhatsApp Business API provider •

Expected impact of government decisions: VAT (15%) applies to subscription and commission revenue; municipal/commercial registration fees apply to company formation; SME-focused Monsha'at programs may reduce some setup costs and offer financing support •

11. Business Model

No.	Product/Service	Delivery Method	Distribution Method	Pricing Method
1	Booking & Matchmaking	Mobile app (iOS/Android)	App Store / Google Play, WhatsApp bot	Commission per booking, paid by venue
2	Premium Subscription	In-app subscription	In-app purchase	Monthly/annual subscription fee
3	B2B Venue Dashboard	Web dashboard + mobile	Direct B2B sales	Monthly SaaS licensing fee
4	Corporate Wellness Packages	Bulk booking allocation via dashboard	Direct B2B sales to HR/wellness teams	Recurring contract fee

Beyond direct profit, PlayGCC gains proprietary data on sports participation patterns across Saudi cities, which strengthens the demand-forecasting product sold to venues and positions the company as a long-term data partner for sports infrastructure planning aligned with Vision 2030.

12. General Risk Factors

Internal Characteristics

- Small founding team relative to the scope of features planned (booking, matchmaking, AI, B2B tools) may slow delivery
- Dependence on a few early venue partners for initial supply/liquidity in each city

External Market Characteristics

- A well-capitalized competitor (regional or global) could enter with faster execution or lower pricing
 - Changes in payment, identity-verification, or data-protection regulation could require costly technical rework
 - Economic expectations: broadly favorable given Vision 2030 spending, but sensitive to oil-price-driven shifts in government spending priorities
- Mitigation: start with a single city (Riyadh) to concentrate venue supply and liquidity before expanding; keep the core team lean and outsource non-core technical work where possible; build compliance (Nafath, VAT, data protection) into the product from day one rather than retrofitting it.

13. Capability

Question	Assessment
Do you have the necessary skills to execute the business activity?	Partially — technical/product skills assumed present in the founding team; sports-industry and B2B sales experience would need to be hired or advised in
Can you provide the required materials and tools?	Yes — all required inputs (cloud hosting, payment/identity APIs) are commercially available and do not require custom hardware
Do you have sufficient experience to complete the business activity?	Limited — as a student/early-stage venture, experience gaps exist in venue sales and Saudi regulatory processes; addressed via advisors and Monsha'at SME support programs
Do you have sufficient financial resources to start the business activity?	Not yet — the business requires the seed capital identified in Section 15 before development and hiring can begin at the planned scale

14. Financial Expectations

The figures below are illustrative three-year projections for academic purposes and should be replaced with a fully modeled financial plan before real fundraising. All amounts are in SAR.

Income Statement (Illustrative)

	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Sales (Net Sales)	800,000	3,500,000	9,000,000
Cost of Sales	(300,000)	(1,100,000)	(2,600,000)
Administrative & Marketing Expenses	(1,500,000)	(1,900,000)	(3,900,000)
Operating Profit	(1,000,000)	500,000	2,500,000
Zakat (if applicable)	—	(12,500)	(62,500)
Net Profit	(1,000,000)	487,500	2,437,500

Break-even and Cost/Revenue Analysis

Based on this projection, PlayGCC is expected to reach operating break-even in Year 2, roughly 18–20 months after launch, once the venue network and subscription base reach sufficient scale in Riyadh and Jeddah. Continued, stable profitability depends on maintaining venue-side commission volume and growing the B2B SaaS and corporate wellness lines, which carry higher margins than the consumer commission business alone.

15. Capital Requirements and Strategy

No.	Source	Timing	Amount (SAR)
1	Founders' equity	Month 0	300,000
2	Seed investors / angel round	Months 2–3	1,800,000
3	Monsha'at / SME support programs (grants, subsidized loans)	Months 3–6	400,000
4	Total		2,500,000

This capital covers the Year 1 operating loss shown in Section 14 plus a working-capital buffer, funding the team through trial and grand opening. Expected revenue and the growing venue and subscriber base described in Sections 6 and 14 form the basis for securing this financing, alongside the market validation provided by this feasibility study.

Debt-to-equity ratio: kept low at this stage, targeting equity and grant funding over debt in Year 1, given • limited hard collateral

Return on investment: investors are expected to see the business approach break-even in Year 2, with • returns realistically expected from Year 3 onward or a future funding round, once the venue network and B2B SaaS line are established

16. Results and Recommendations

This feasibility study finds that PlayGCC addresses a real and currently unaddressed gap in the Saudi sports market: no existing competitor combines multi-sport, multi-venue booking with a trust-and-safety layer built for playing with new people, and no competitor is built Saudi-first around Nafath verification, Arabic-language design, and local payment norms.

Positives:

- Strong, government-backed market growth (padel courts, Vision 2030 sports-participation targets) reduces demand risk
- Clear differentiation from all identified competitors on both product and geography
- Multiple, complementary revenue streams (commission, subscription, B2B SaaS, corporate wellness) reduce reliance on a single income source

Negatives / risks:

- Execution risk from a small founding team relative to the scope of planned features
 - Dependence on early venue partnerships to establish liquidity in each city before network effects take hold
 - Competitive risk from better-funded entrants copying the core booking or matchmaking features
- Overall, the business activity appears economically viable, provided PlayGCC launches narrowly in Riyadh to prove liquidity and trust mechanisms before expanding, and secures the seed capital identified in Section 15 to fund the team through break-even. The recommendation is to proceed with the business activity, starting with the phased MVP scope defined in the accompanying market study and business model canvas.